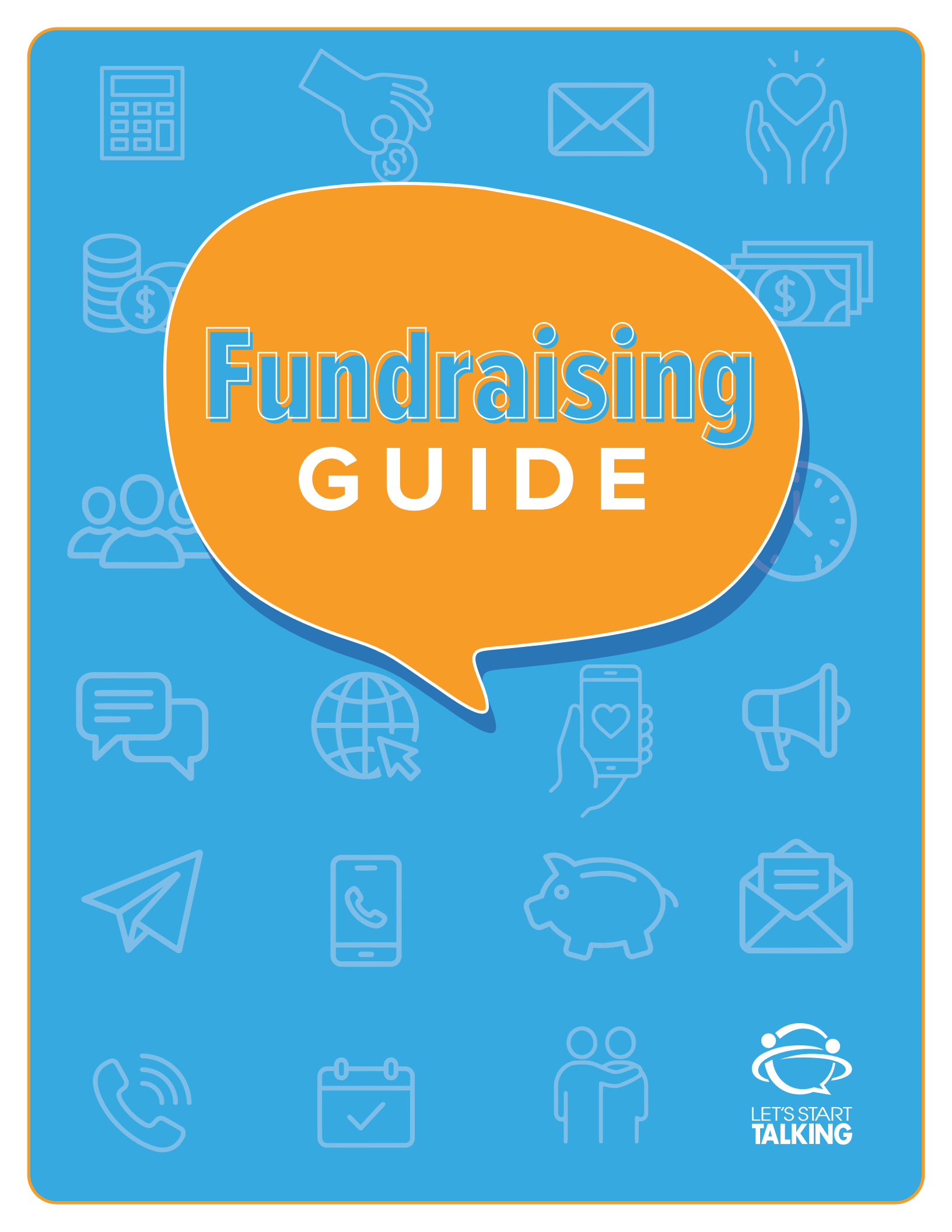


The background is a solid blue color with a grid of 20 white line-art icons. The icons include: a calculator, a hand holding a coin, an envelope, hands holding a heart, a stack of coins, a stack of bills, a group of people, a clock, two speech bubbles, a globe with a cursor, a hand holding a smartphone with a heart, a megaphone, a paper airplane, a smartphone with a call icon, a piggy bank, an open envelope, a telephone handset, a calendar with a checkmark, two people standing, and the 'Let's Start Talking' logo in the bottom right corner.

Fundraising GUIDE



Money is a tool God uses to help us live and love like Jesus. Regardless of how much – or how little – money we have, God is at work in our lives through our circumstances, and He is leading us to a deeper trust in him.

(Reference: Jesse Wisnewski – Tithe.ly)

Why raise money?

Fundraising Is Ministry!

Fundraising is ministry when we present to the world a Kingdom vision and invite others to join in a specific mission. It doesn't matter if we are the ones asking or giving, God is bringing His people together in collaboration to accomplish His work. When those with money and those who need money share a common mission, then we see a central sign of new life in the Spirit of Jesus Christ. The giver and the receiver both meet on the common ground of God's love. When this happens we can truly say, "There is a new creation!" (2 Cor. 5:17) (reference: Loretto Foundation)

First Things First

- You are raising funds for LST, not just for your particular LST project. Click <https://lst.org/projects/general-financial-information/> to see LST Financial Policy.
- You are inviting – not begging. Giving in support of ministry brings people great joy! This is an opportunity for donors to participate in life-changing ministry.
- You should raise funds even if you don't think you need to. God brings people together in collaboration to accomplish His work!
- God will provide what you need! (2 Cor. 9:8)

How should I think about fundraising?

Before you actually begin fundraising, it's critical to examine the way we think about fundraising.

Successful fundraisers don't just DO the right kinds of things; they THINK the right kinds of thoughts.

First, pray. We don't make people give. We just ask. God opens hearts in response to our asking. Our primary job in fundraising is simply to ask. So, pray now. Pray tomorrow. Pray every day of this fundraising journey.'

Second, develop a healthy framework for fundraising. Fundraising is not something we do in order to get to the real ministry; it is part of our ministry. There is an emotional and psychological aspect to raising support. We may hinder our own efforts at fundraising if we're carrying negative emotions, thoughts, or even the memories of negative experiences with us as we move forward.



What is my fundraising strategy?

While there are a number of factors that might impact your fundraising, some strategies seem to yield greater results. Consider the following response rates when mapping out your strategy:

- **Face-to-face** – Expect a 75%-80% response rate.
- **Phone** – Expect a 50%-60% response rate.
- **Written or Electronic Requests** (such as letter writing) – Expect a 15%-20% response rate.
- **Low Priority** (send a few texts and post once on social media) – Expect 0% response rate.

As you contemplate specific action steps to take, meditate on the following principles from Scripture:

God is creator, owner, and provider.

And God will generously provide all you need. Then you will always have everything you need and plenty left over to share with others.

– 2 COR. 9:8

We are all stewards.

God has given each of you a gift from his great variety of spiritual gifts. Use them well to serve one another. – 1 PETER 4:10

There is a special blessing for those who give.

You should remember the words of the Lord Jesus: “It is more blessed to give than to receive.” – ACTS 20:35

God uses people to financially support His work.

Soon afterward Jesus began a tour of the nearby towns and villages, preaching and announcing the Good News about the Kingdom of God. He took his twelve disciples with him, along with some women who had been cured of evil spirits and diseases. Among them were Mary Magdalene, from whom he had cast out seven demons; Joanna, the wife of Chuza, Herod’s business manager; Susanna; and many others who were contributing from their own resources to support Jesus and his disciples. – LUKE 8:1-3

Always be thankful.

Be thankful in all circumstances, for this is God’s will for you who belong to Christ Jesus. – 1 THESS. 5:18



Person-to-Person Fundraising

- Asking your friends and family face-to-face (or phone-to-phone)
- You will raise more funds more quickly using this strategy.
- Relationally this is a powerful means of building a fundraising team.
- Because the response rate is higher you may actually raise all your funds from a smaller group of donors.

Tips for Person-to-Person Fundraising

- Make a list of the people you want to talk to.
- Create a small script for your interaction and practice it.
- Where you're going and who you're going with
 - The need LST is addressing:
 - LST provides a meaningful way for Christians to serve others.
 - LST provides a vehicle for sharing faith non-confrontationally.
 - LST provides a bridge for mission churches to reach into their neighborhoods.
 - LST meets these needs by offering one-to-one English conversation practice; free of charge; Scripture-based conversations; non-confrontational; etc.
 - Your financial need
 - The "ask" – "Can you be part of my support team?"
- Show them you have a plan: For example: "I'm asking 39 people to each give \$100 to meet my goal. Would you be willing to help?"
- If calling:
 - It's ok to leave a message, but call again later.
 - Call during convenient times: 4 p.m.-8 p.m.
 - Be confident and specific with your conversation. It helps to write out what you want to say.
- Provide a way for them to respond immediately (link to online donation page)



E-Strategies (Social media and email)

- Short, concise, fundraising requests to a larger network of potential donors
- Easier to include photos and/or video
- Doesn't cost anything
- Can be forwarded/shared by others
- Less likely to be read or noticed
- Very short "shelf life"

- Can send requests more often - which counters some of the negatives mentioned above

Example Two-Week Social Media Blitz:

Schedule messages about your trip and your fundraising request to go out once a day, Monday-Friday, for two weeks. Use a message on Saturday and Sunday to highlight something you're looking forward to about your project. Don't ask in those messages. Grab attention by emphasizing this is a two-week blitz. Consider having a goal for your blitz "I need to raise \$2,000 during this two week blitz..."

Tips for E-Strategies

- Create several short descriptions of your project and your fundraising needs. Be concise!
- Include photos – your team, your training, your site, etc.
- Ask others to share your requests to their networks.
- Always include a link to your online donation page..)



Letter Writing

- Can be a good supplement to other fundraising methods.
- Can set the stage for person-to-person fundraising. "I'll be calling you in the next few days to let you know more about how to join me..."
- Longer "shelf life"
- Will generally have a low response rate
- Can be labor intensive (printing letters, printing envelopes, stuffing, etc.)

Tips for Letter Writing

- Be concise. Not more than one page.
- Personalize each letter.
- Sign each letter.
- Include a link to your fundraising page. Encourage online giving but provide a response envelope in case they need to send a check.
- Include your fundraising deadlines.
- If relying on this for your primary means of fundraising, you will probably have to send 2-3 rounds of letters. Use a previous list as your starting point, such as Christmas cards, graduation announcements, or other similar events.
- Plan to send out at least 100-200 letters.

General fundraising tips

40+ Years of LST Fundraising Experience:

- Make your “ask” about the donor not about you. Help them see what will happen when they give – a Reader will have the opportunity to improve their English, a church will gain access to new relationships in their community, etc.
- Tell stories such as how you decided to go, what training is like, stories from the LST about Readers and Workers, etc.
- Always ask for a specific amount and give a specific deadline for giving.
- Urgency motivates people to give, so continue asking right up to the last minute.
- Ask people who have supported you before.
- The easiest way for people to give is online. Encourage donors to give through your LST web page.
- Most contributions come from individuals you know well, not from church budgets.
- Don’t pre-judge who will give or how much they will give. You may be surprised at who gives and who doesn’t.
- Fundraising is rewarding and faith-building, but it takes work.
- For some people the donations come quickly, and for others they come very slowly.
- People are more likely to give if they know you are fully committed. Never say, “If I raise my funds then I’m going...”
- Some donors may wait to give until they know their donation is really needed, so make your request with urgency.
- God will bless your efforts, if you will show Him your diligence.

Sample Phrases to use in your communication:

- “I will be sharing the story of Jesus with people every day, while we help them practice their conversational English.”
- “We are serving people by helping them improve their conversation English using God’s word.”
- “I’d love to call/meet and tell you about this opportunity. Would X day/time work?”
- “I’ve committed to raise (amount) for LST.”
- “My fundraising goal is (amount), and my first deadline is (date).”
- “I’m asking (#) people to give \$100 each to help me meet my goal.”
- “The easiest way to give is online. Here’s the link to my LST fundraising page...”
- “Could you be part of my support team?”
- When someone says “No”:
 - “I understand that this may not be a good time. If you don’t mind, could I check back with you next month to see if that’s a better time?”
 - “I understand. Could I add you to my report list so that I can keep you updated on my project?”

- When someone says, “Let me get back to you about your request:”
 - “Sure! Could I contact you next Friday and see if you’ve had time to consider my request?”
- “Do you know anyone else who might be interested in supporting me in this LST project?”
- “Thank you!”

Fundraising with Gratitude

The best fundraisers cover everything in prayer and gratitude. We ask God, friends, and family to become part of this ministry through their gifts—and then we thank them for joining us.

A few simple practices:

- Thank everyone who takes the time to consider your request, whether or not they give.
- Thank every donor personally within 48 hours.
- Whenever possible, use a handwritten thank-you note—not just a text or email.
- Keep donors updated as you reach your fundraising goal.
- Stay connected even after you’ve reached your goal:
 - Share updates about your training and preparation.
 - Ask them to pray for your team.
 - Keep them informed during your project.
 - Send them a final report when you return.

Ultimately, everything we do at Let’s Start Talking is about relationships— our relationship with God, our team, our Readers, our Host, and our donors. Treat your donors with care, respect, and deep gratitude. They may not be going with you, **but they are part of your team.** Their prayers, encouragement, and generosity are helping make your LST Project possible.

*Not that I am speaking of being in need,
for I have learned in whatever situation I am
to be content. I know how to be brought low,
and I know how to abound. In any and
every circumstance, I have learned the
secret of facing plenty and hunger,
abundance and need.*

PHILPPIANS 4:11-12



Fundraising

ACTION PLAN

Use the space below to write what LST has told you concerning the amount you need to raise and what your actual fundraising deadlines are.

My fundraising goal:

First fundraising deadline:

Last fundraising deadline:

Amount Due	Due Date
\$2,000	90 days prior to departure
100%	30 days prior to departure

Fill out the chart below by indicating an action you will take, the date by which you'll take that action, and the amount of support you anticipate the action will bring. Keep in mind the different response rates mentioned above.

Action Summary	By Date	Amount Anticipated
For example: Call 10 potential donors to set up ask-appointments	February 1	NA
For example: Meet with 5 donors to ask face-to-face or online	February 15	\$1,000

4 months from departure I've raised:	3 months from departure I've raised:	2 months from departure I've raised:	1 month from departure I've raised:	0 months from departure I've raised:
\$	\$	\$	\$	\$